

GVA DOWNLOADER

Version 2.0

Fast • Portable • Cross-Platform

COMPLETE USER GUIDE

Setup & Usage for Windows · Android (Termux) · Linux · macOS

Engine: yt-dlp | Interface: Rich (Terminal)
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1. Introduction

GVA Downloader is a terminal-based media downloader built on top of yt-dlp and Rich. Version 2.0 is fully portable: every file the app creates — settings, history, logs, cache — stays inside the same folder as the program itself, so you can copy that folder anywhere and keep working.

1.1 What's New in This Version

- One self-contained application folder — no hidden files in your home directory
- Videos and audio are automatically kept in separate folders
- Direct URL downloads from the command line
- Share-to-download workflow for Android (Termux)
- Duplicate-file protection with Skip / Overwrite / Rename / Cancel
- Safer filenames on every platform, including Windows
- A single, clean progress bar per download (instead of multiple stacked bars)

1.2 Key Features

Feature	Description
Video Download	Dynamic quality list pulled straight from the source (up to 4K where available)
Audio Download	MP3, M4A, AAC, FLAC, OGG, WAV with selectable bitrate
Playlist Download	Full playlist or a custom range, as video or audio
YouTube Search	Search and download without leaving the terminal
Batch Downloads	Paste multiple links or load them from a text file
Media Information	Preview title, uploader, duration, views, and available qualities
Download History	Searchable log of everything you've downloaded
Settings	Download folder, default qualities, theme, overwrite behavior
Engine Maintenance	Update yt-dlp and clear caches from inside the app
Direct URL Mode	Run the script with a link and skip the main menu

2. Requirements

Before installing, make sure you have the following:

Requirement	Notes
Python 3.9 or newer	Required on every platform
FFmpeg	Needed to merge video/audio, convert audio formats, and embed thumbnails
yt-dlp (Python package)	Installed automatically by the installer scripts, or via pip
rich (Python package)	Installed automatically by the installer scripts, or via pip
Internet connection	Required for downloading media and updating yt-dlp

Tip

You don't need to install Python packages manually — the included `install_windows.bat` and `install_termux.sh` scripts do it for you.

3. Installation on Windows

3.1 Option A — Automatic (Recommended)

Download or clone the GVA Downloader project folder, then run the installer:

1. Extract or clone the “GVA Downloader” folder anywhere, e.g. Desktop or Documents.
2. Open the folder and double-click `install_windows.bat`.
3. Wait for it to install Python packages (yt-dlp, rich) and check for FFmpeg.
4. If FFmpeg is missing, follow the on-screen instructions in Section 3.3.
5. Done! Launch the app as shown in Section 3.4.

3.2 Option B — Manual Setup

Open Command Prompt or PowerShell inside the GVA Downloader folder and run:

```
python -m pip install -U yt-dlp rich
```

Don't have Python?

Install it from python.org/downloads. During setup, make sure to check “Add python.exe to PATH” — this is required.

3.3 Installing FFmpeg on Windows

1. Go to ffmpeg.org/download.html and download a Windows build (e.g. from gyan.dev).
2. Extract the ZIP file anywhere, e.g. `C:\ffmpeg`.

3. Copy the path to its “bin” folder, e.g. C:\ffmpeg\bin.
4. Open “Edit the system environment variables” → Environment Variables → select Path → Edit → New, then paste the bin path.
5. Restart Command Prompt and confirm with: ffmpeg -version

3.4 Launching GVA Downloader

From inside the GVA Downloader folder, run:

```
python gva_downloader.py
```

The main menu should appear immediately.

4. Installation on Android (Termux)

Termux is a free terminal emulator for Android. GVA Downloader runs natively inside it.

4.1 Install Termux

- Install Termux from F-Droid (recommended) or GitHub Releases. The Google Play Store version is outdated — avoid it.

4.2 Option A — Automatic Setup

1. Install git: `pkg install git -y`
2. Clone or copy the project: `git clone <repository-url> "GVA Downloader"`
3. Move into the folder: `cd "GVA Downloader"`
4. Run the installer: `bash install_termux.sh`
5. When prompted, allow storage access (termux-setup-storage) so downloads can be saved to your phone's storage.
6. When asked about the Share workflow, type y if you want to share videos from YouTube directly (see Section 6).

4.3 Option B — Manual Setup

```
pkg update -y
pkg install python ffmpeg -y
pip install -U yt-dlp rich
termux-setup-storage
```

4.4 Launching GVA Downloader

```
python gva_downloader.py
```

Storage tip

Run `termux-setup-storage` once so Termux can access your phone's shared storage. Point the Download Folder setting at a path under `~/storage/downloads/` if you want downloads visible in your phone's Files app.

5. Installation on Linux / macOS

5.1 Linux (Debian/Ubuntu example)

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt install python3 python3-pip ffmpeg -y
pip3 install -U yt-dlp rich
```

5.2 macOS

Using Homebrew:

```
brew install python ffmpeg
pip3 install -U yt-dlp rich
```

5.3 Launching GVA Downloader

```
python3 gva_downloader.py
```

6. First Run & Folder Structure

The very first time you run `gva_downloader.py`, it automatically creates every folder it needs — no manual setup required:

```
GVA Downloader/
├── gva_downloader.py
├── README.md
├── install_windows.bat
├── install_termux.sh
├── downloads/
│   ├── videos/      <- all downloaded videos go here
│   └── audios/       <- all downloaded audio goes here
├── config/
│   └── settings.json
├── history/
│   └── history.json
```

```

├── logs/
│   └── gva_downloader.log
├── cache/
└── temp/

```

6.1 Why This Matters

- Everything GVA owns stays inside this one folder — nothing is written to your home directory or AppData.
- You can copy the entire “GVA Downloader” folder to a USB drive or another computer, and your settings/history/logs travel with it.
- Videos and audio never mix — they are kept in separate subfolders automatically.

7. Using the App — Main Menu Walkthrough

Launch the app and you'll see the main menu:

```

1. 🎬 Download Video
2. 🎵 Download Audio
3. 📋 Playlist Download (Video/Audio)
4. 🔍 Search YouTube & Download
5. 📁 Batch Downloads (List/File)
6. ⓘ Media Information
7. ⌚ Download History
8. ⚙️ Settings
9. 🛠️ Engine Maintenance
10. ? Help
11. 📖 About
12. 🚪 Exit

```

Type the number of the option you want and press Enter. Below is what each option does.

7.1 Download Video (Option 1)

1. Paste the video URL when prompted.
2. GVA fetches the title and shows every real available quality (e.g. 1080p, 4K).
3. Choose a quality, then answer the follow-up prompts: subtitles, embed metadata, embed thumbnail, and SponsorBlock.
4. Confirm or change the output folder (default: downloads/videos).
5. Watch the single progress bar until it finishes.

7.2 Download Audio (Option 2)

1. Paste the video or audio URL.
2. Pick a bitrate and an output format (MP3, M4A, AAC, FLAC, OGG, or WAV).
3. Choose whether to embed metadata and cover art.
4. Confirm the output folder (default: downloads/audios).

7.3 Playlist Download (Option 3)

1. Paste the playlist URL.
2. GVA lists the first 10 items and the total count.
3. Choose to download the entire playlist or a specific range (e.g. 1-10).
4. Choose video or audio mode, then the quality/format.
5. Files are saved with playlist index prefixes, e.g. "01 - Title.mp4".

7.4 Search YouTube & Download (Option 4)

1. Type a search query.
2. Pick a result from the list of up to 7 matches.
3. Choose video or audio, and GVA hands off to the normal download flow.

7.5 Batch Downloads (Option 5)

1. Choose to paste multiple URLs at once, or load them from a text file (one URL per line).
2. Choose video or audio mode for the whole batch.
3. GVA downloads each link one after another, showing progress for each.

7.6 Media Information (Option 6)

Paste a URL to preview its title, uploader, duration, view count, and every available resolution/bitrate — without downloading anything.

7.7 Download History (Option 7)

- View History — see every past download with date, title, type, and file location
- Search History — filter by title, site, or URL
- Open Download Location — opens your downloads folder in the system file manager
- Delete History Entry — remove a single record
- Clear History — wipe the whole history list

7.8 Settings (Option 8)

Covered in full detail in Section 8.

7.9 Engine Maintenance (Option 9)

- Update yt-dlp library — keeps extraction working as sites change
- Clear yt-dlp Cache — clears yt-dlp's internal cache
- Clear GVA Cache & Temp Folders — clears the app's own cache/ and temp/ folders

8. Settings Reference

Open Settings from the main menu (Option 8), or jump straight to it from the command line:

```
python gva_downloader.py --settings
```

Setting	What It Does
1. Download Folder	Where finished downloads are saved. Accepts a relative path (default: downloads, kept portable inside the app folder) or an absolute path (e.g. D:\My Downloads\GVA). GVA always creates videos/ and audios/ subfolders inside it.
2. Video Quality	Your default video quality label, shown as a reference in Settings.
3. Audio Quality	Your default audio quality label, shown as a reference in Settings.
4. Theme	Terminal color theme: default, ocean, or sunset.
5. Overwrite Existing Files	When ON, GVA overwrites duplicate files automatically without asking. When OFF (default), you'll be asked Skip / Overwrite / Rename / Cancel.
6. Reset Settings	Restores every setting above to its default value.

Important

Even if you change the Download Folder to somewhere outside the app, your config, history, logs, cache, and temp files always stay inside the GVA Downloader folder.

9. Direct URL & Command-Line Usage

You don't have to open the main menu every time. GVA Downloader accepts a URL directly on the command line.

9.1 Quick Download Menu

```
python gva_downloader.py "https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XXXXXXXXXX"
python gva_downloader.py --url "https://youtu.be/XXXXXXXXXX"
```

This shows a compact menu instead of the full main menu:

```

URL detected
🎬 Title: Example Video

1. Download Video
2. Download Audio
3. Download Best Quality
4. View Information
5. Cancel

```

9.2 All Command-Line Options

Command	What It Does
<code>python gva_downloader.py</code>	Opens the normal interactive main menu
<code>python gva_downloader.py "URL"</code>	Opens the quick “URL detected” menu
<code>python gva_downloader.py --url "URL"</code>	Same as above, explicit flag form
<code>python gva_downloader.py --video "URL"</code>	Jumps straight to a video quality prompt and downloads to downloads/videos
<code>python gva_downloader.py --audio "URL"</code>	Jumps straight to an audio format prompt and downloads to downloads/audios
<code>python gva_downloader.py --info "URL"</code>	Shows media information only — no download
<code>python gva_downloader.py --history</code>	Prints your download history and exits
<code>python gva_downloader.py --settings</code>	Opens the Settings menu directly
<code>python gva_downloader.py --help</code>	Shows all available options

Supported link types include standard YouTube links,youtu.be short links, and YouTube Shorts — and anything else yt-dlp’s extractor system recognizes.

10. Share-to-Download Workflow (Android / Termux)

Once set up, you can share a video from the YouTube app straight to GVA Downloader — no copy-pasting the link.

10.1 How It Works

```

YouTube App
  ↓ tap Share
Termux
  ↓ runs ~/bin/termux-url-opener
GVA Downloader
  ↓

```

Quick Download Menu appears automatically

10.2 Automatic Setup

The Termux installer (install_termux.sh) offers to configure this for you. If you skipped it, set it up manually below.

10.3 Manual Setup

1. Create the bin folder: `mkdir -p ~/bin`
2. Create the opener script: `nano ~/bin/termux-url-opener`
3. Paste the following, replacing the path with your actual project path:

```
#!/data/data/com.termux/files/usr/bin/bash
python "/path/to/GVA Downloader/gva_downloader.py" "$1"
```

4. Save the file, then make it executable: `chmod +x ~/bin/termux-url-opener`
5. Open the YouTube app, tap Share on any video, and choose Termux.

Result

GVA Downloader opens automatically with the shared link ready in the Quick Download Menu — just pick Video, Audio, or Best Quality.

11. Duplicate Files & Filename Safety

11.1 Duplicate File Handling

If a file with the same name already exists in the target folder, GVA Downloader will ask what to do (unless Overwrite Existing Files is turned on in Settings):

```
File already exists: Example Video.mp4
```

- ```
1) Skip
2) Overwrite
3) Save with a new filename
4) Cancel
```

### 11.2 Safe Filenames

Titles are automatically cleaned up before being used as filenames:

- Illegal characters ( < > : " / \ | ? \* ) are replaced
- Windows-reserved names (CON, PRN, COM1, etc.) are automatically prefixed
- Trailing dots and spaces are removed

- Overly long titles are safely shortened while keeping the file extension
- Unicode titles (e.g. Japanese, Arabic, emoji) are preserved wherever possible

## 12. Troubleshooting

| Problem                                  | Fix                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| “FFmpeg is not installed”                | Windows: install from <a href="https://ffmpeg.org">ffmpeg.org</a> and add to PATH. Termux: <code>pkg install ffmpeg</code> . Linux: <code>sudo apt install ffmpeg</code> . macOS: <code>brew install ffmpeg</code> . |
| Download fails or extraction error       | Update yt-dlp: Engine Maintenance → Update yt-dlp library, or run <code>pip install -U yt-dlp</code> .                                                                                                               |
| “This video is private / age-restricted” | GVA cannot bypass authentication or access controls. You must be authorized to access the content.                                                                                                                   |
| Files not visible on my phone            | Run <code>termux-setup-storage</code> and set the Download Folder to a path under <code>~/storage/downloads/</code> .                                                                                                |
| Duplicate-file prompt appears every time | Turn on Overwrite Existing Files in Settings if you always want to overwrite.                                                                                                                                        |
| “Permission denied” while saving         | Choose a folder you have write access to, or run the app with appropriate permissions.                                                                                                                               |
| Multiple progress bars appear            | Update to the latest <code>gva_downloader.py</code> — this was fixed to show a single progress line per download.                                                                                                    |
| python: command not found                | On Linux/macOS/Termux, try <code>python3</code> instead of <code>python</code> .                                                                                                                                     |

Every technical error is also written to `logs/gva_downloader.log` for deeper troubleshooting.

## 13. Frequently Asked Questions

### Can I move the GVA Downloader folder after using it?

Yes. Copy the entire folder anywhere — your settings, history, and downloads move with it, as long as they're all inside the folder.

### Does GVA Downloader work without an internet connection?

No. An internet connection is required to fetch media information and download content.

### Can I download from sites other than YouTube?

Yes, if yt-dlp's extractor system supports the site. GVA Downloader does not do any custom scraping.

**Will this bypass private videos, paywalls, or DRM?**

No. GVA Downloader will not and cannot bypass authentication, paywalls, or DRM protections.

**How do I update yt-dlp?**

Use Engine Maintenance → Update yt-dlp library from the main menu, or run: `pip install -U yt-dlp`

**Where are my settings stored?**

In config/settings.json, inside the GVA Downloader application folder — never in a hidden system folder.

## 14. Responsible Use

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GVA Downloader uses yt-dlp as its download engine and performs no custom scraping. It does not bypass DRM, authentication, or paywalls.

Only use this application to download content you are authorized to access and download, and always respect the terms of service of the websites you use it with.

## 15. Quick Command Cheat Sheet

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| Goal                    | Command                                             |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Install on Windows      | <code>install_windows.bat</code>                    |
| Install on Termux       | <code>bash install_termux.sh</code>                 |
| Run the app             | <code>python gva_downloader.py</code>               |
| Download a video by URL | <code>python gva_downloader.py "URL"</code>         |
| Quick video download    | <code>python gva_downloader.py --video "URL"</code> |
| Quick audio download    | <code>python gva_downloader.py --audio "URL"</code> |
| View info only          | <code>python gva_downloader.py --info "URL"</code>  |
| View history            | <code>python gva_downloader.py --history</code>     |
| Open settings           | <code>python gva_downloader.py --settings</code>    |
| Update yt-dlp           | <code>pip install -U yt-dlp</code>                  |
| See all options         | <code>python gva_downloader.py --help</code>        |